RHYTHM · STEP 1

Feel the beat

Beat or rhythm?

★☆☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 AT THE PIANO FREE PRINTABLE R1-01

Play any piece (or listen to one). Tap your foot on the beat and clap the rhythm of the tune. Then swap: clap the beat, tap the rhythm.

Foot beat, hands rhythm ○ ○ ○

Hands beat, foot rhythm ○ ○ ○

Slow to fast

★☆☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 PUZZLE FREE PRINTABLE R1-02

Number the metronome marks from the slowest (1) to the fastest (4).

♩ = 120	♩ = 60	♩ = 92	♩ = 76
☐	☐	☐	☐

Strong beats

★☆☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 WRITE IT R1-03

Each dot is one beat. Circle the strong beat in every bar; in 4/4, also underline the medium beat.

2/4 ● ● | ● ● |

3/4 ● ● ● | ● ● ● |

4/4 ● ● ● ● | ● ● ● ● |

Two, three or four?

★★☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 LISTEN R1-04

Someone plays a piece, or a march, a waltz and a song online. Count along and decide how many beats are in each bar.

MUSIC	BEATS IN A BAR
_____	2 · 3 · 4
_____	2 · 3 · 4
_____	2 · 3 · 4

Tempo ladder

★★☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 CHALLENGE FREE PRINTABLE R1-05

Clap the line while counting aloud. Tick a step each time it is steady, then move the metronome up.



♩ = 60	♩ = 72	♩ = 84	♩ = 96	♩ = 108
○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○

Walk the beat

★☆☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 AT THE PIANO R1-06

Set the metronome to ♩ = 80. Walk one step on every beat, saying the counts. Stop on beat 1 when someone says “freeze”.

2/4 (left, right)	○ ○ ○
3/4 (a step and a sway)	○ ○ ○
4/4	○ ○ ○

RHYTHM · STEP 2

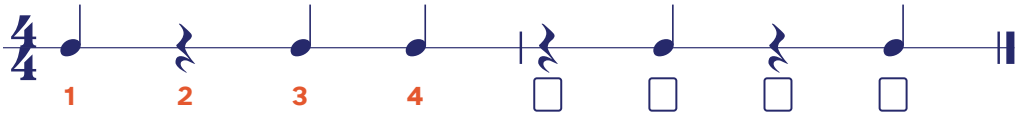
Crotchets and crotchet rests

Count it

★☆☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS LEVEL 0 WRITE IT R2-01

Write a count in every box. Count the rests too: they are beats of silence.

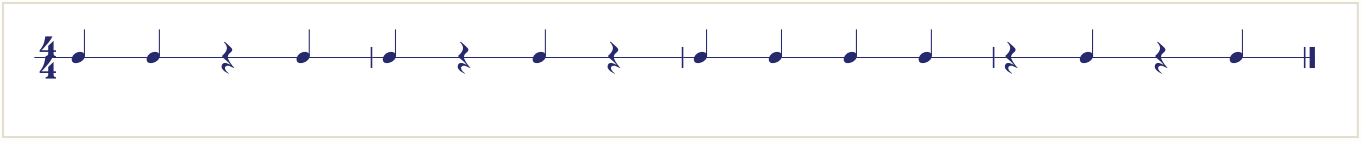


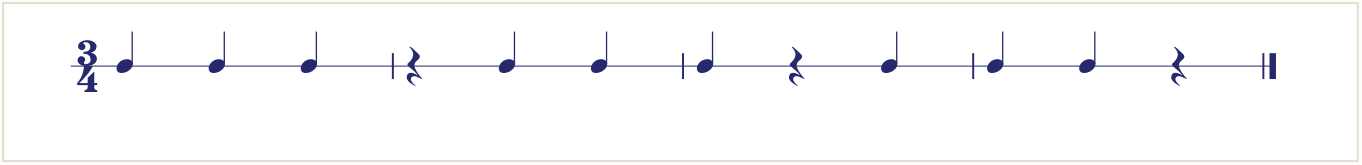
Clap and open

★☆☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS · LEVEL 0 · AT THE PIANO · FREE PRINTABLE · R2-02

Clap on every crotchet; open your hands wide on every rest. Count aloud.





Which did you hear?

★★☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS · LEVEL 0 · LISTEN · R2-03

Someone claps one rhythm from the row. Circle A, B or C. Then swap roles.

A 

B 

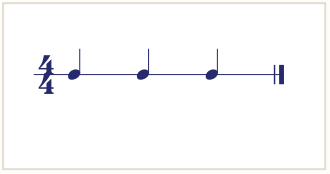
C 

Finish with rests

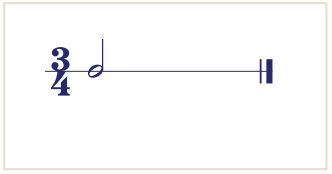
★★☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS · LEVEL 0 · WRITE IT · R2-04

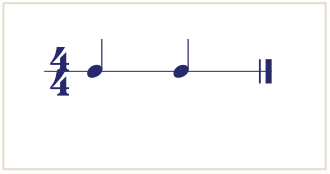
Each bar is short. Complete it with crotchet rests (draw as many as you need).



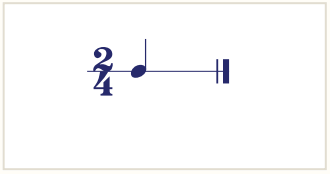
rests ☐



rests ☐



rests ☐



rests ☐

Rhythm echo

★☆☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS · LEVEL 0 · AT THE PIANO · FREE PRINTABLE · R2-05

Someone claps one bar of crotchets and rests; you clap it straight back without a pause. Colour a square for every echo that is exactly right.

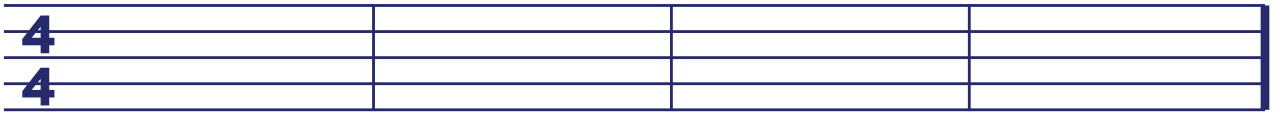
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Rest patterns

★★☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS LEVEL 0 MAKE YOUR OWN R2-06

Make four different bars of 4/4 using crotchets and crotchet rests. No two the same. Clap each one.



Two hands

★★★

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS LEVEL 0 CHALLENGE R2-07

Right hand plays the top line on one key, left hand the bottom line on another. Slowly, then faster.



right hand



left hand

RHYTHM · STEP 3

Minims and semibreves

Count it

★☆☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 WRITE IT R3-01

Write a count in every box: the beat you play, then the beats you hold.

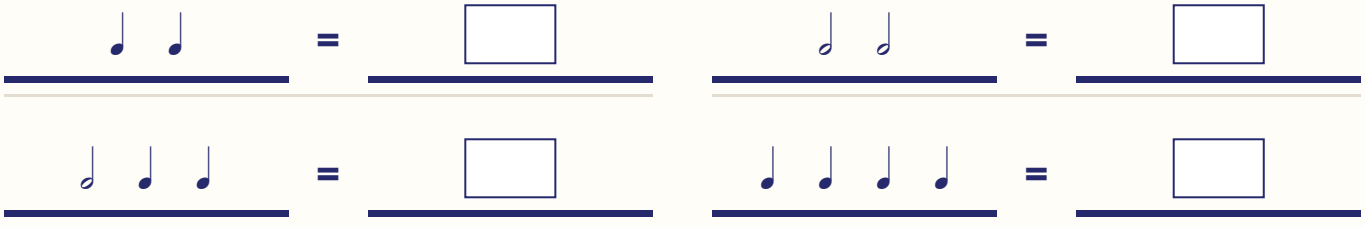


Balance the scales

★☆☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 PUZZLE FREE PRINTABLE R3-02

Write one note on the right so both sides last the same.

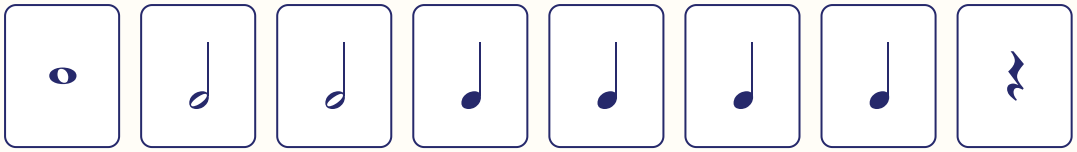


Rhythm dominoes

★★☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 PUZZLE FREE PRINTABLE R3-03

Use the cards to fill one bar of 4/4 exactly (4 beats). How many different ways can you find? Write each way by drawing the notes.



1 _____ 2 _____

3 _____ 4 _____

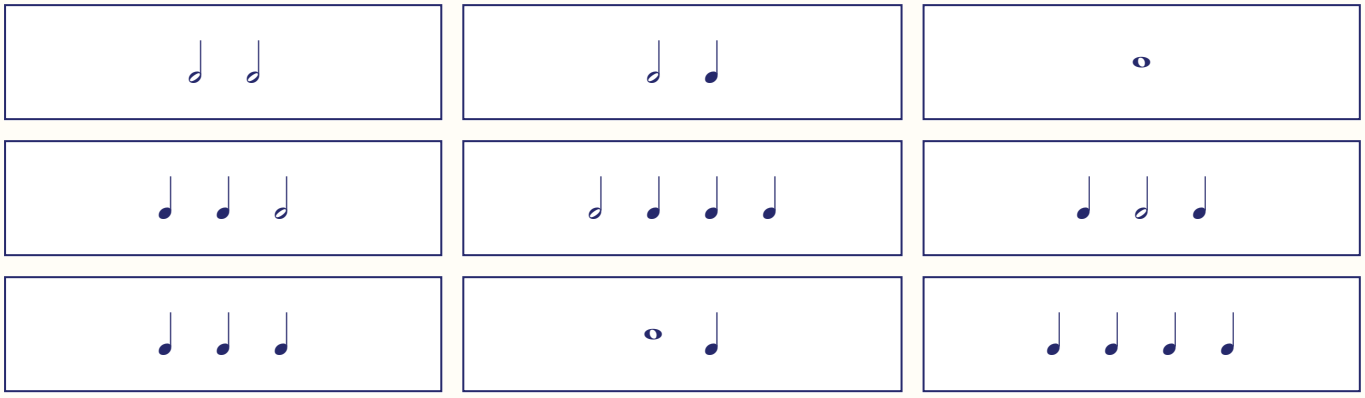
5 _____ 6 _____

Full bar hunt

★★☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 PUZZLE FREE PRINTABLE R3-04

Colour every box that holds exactly four beats.

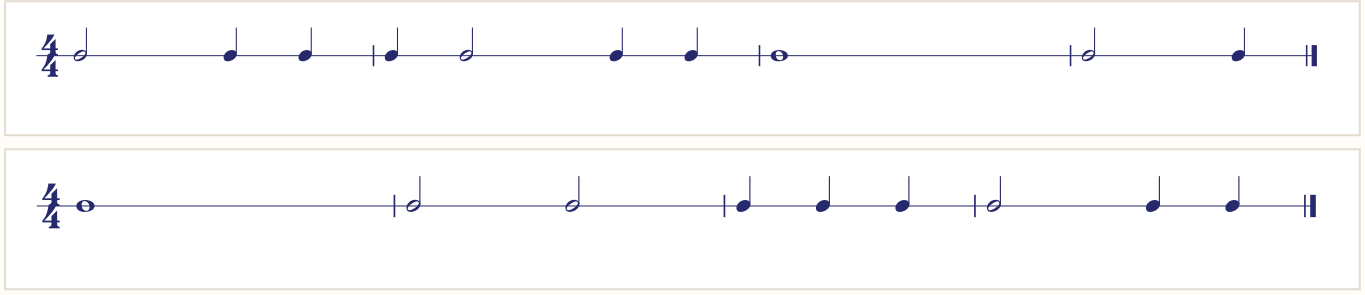


Rhythm detective

★★☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 FIND AND FIX R3-05

Each line has one bar with the wrong number of beats. Circle it and fix it.



Short or long?

★★☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 LISTEN R3-06

Someone claps one rhythm from the row. Circle A, B or C.

A 

B 

C 

Question and answer

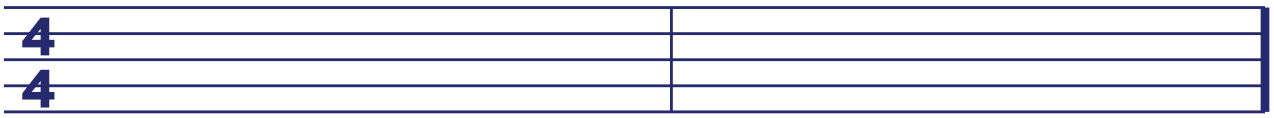
★★★

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 MAKE YOUR OWN R3-07

The first two bars ask a question. Write two bars that answer it, ending on a long note. Play it on one key.



question



In your music

★☆☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 YOUR MUSIC R3-08

Find these in a piece you are learning.

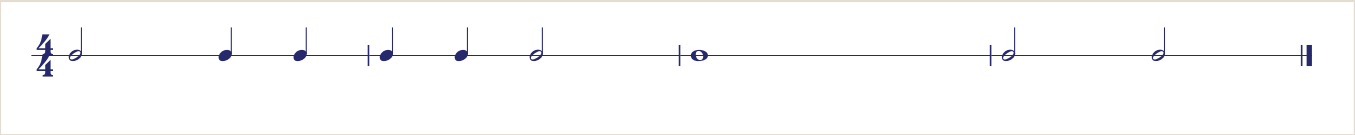
FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
a minim		
a semibreve		
a crotchet rest		
a bar of four crotchets		

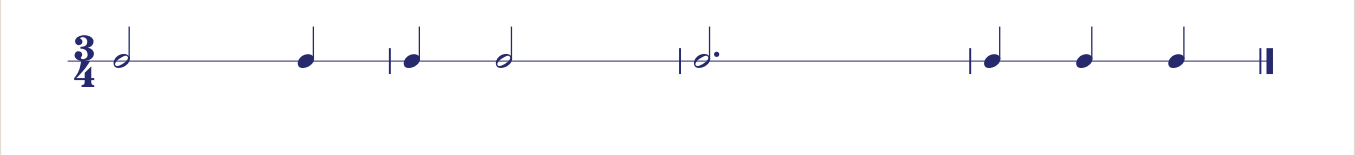
Clap and count

★☆☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 AT THE PIANO FREE PRINTABLE R3-09

Clap and count each line, holding your hands together through the long notes.





RHYTHM · STEPS 1–3

Answers

ACTIVITY	ANSWER
R1-02 Slow to fast	60, 76, 92, 120
R1-03 Strong beats	beat 1 of every bar; in 4/4 also beat 3
R2-01 Count it	1 2 3 4 · 1 2 3 4 (rests on 1 and 3)
R2-04 Finish with rests	1 · 1 · 2 · 1 crotchet rests
R3-01 Count it	1–2 3 4 · 1–2–3–4 · 1 2–3 4
R3-02 Balance the scales	minim · semibreve · semibreve · semibreve
R3-03 Rhythm dominoes	e.g. semibreve · two minims · minim + two crotchets · four crotchets · minim + crotchet + crotchet rest …
R3-04 Full bar hunt	boxes 1, 3, 4, 6, 9
R3-05 Rhythm detective	line 1: bar 2 (5 beats) · line 2: bar 3 (3 beats)